

# Small Teams' Software Deployment Ta

SPECIAL DOCUMENT

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### Team Size vs. Shippability

#### Small Teams, Big Impact

In the world of software development, team size plays an intriguing role in shippability -- the ability to release code safely and efficiently. Small teams often enjoy several advantages:

1. **Closer Collaboration:** In small groups, developers can see each other's screens, discuss issues face-to-face, and iterate quickly. This proximity reduces misunderstandings and accelerates decision-making.

2. **Quicker Feedback Loops:** Smaller teams can get feedback from tests or deployments faster. Issues are identified early and fixed before they spread. The cycle of development, testing, and release is smoother, with fewer bottlenecks.

3. **Flexibility and Adaptability:** Small teams are more agile. They can pivot directions rapidly based on new insights or customer needs without the inertia larger organizations might have. This speed allows them to respond quickly to changes in technology or market dynamics.

4. **\*\*Stronger Ownership:\*\*** Each member of a small team often owns multiple parts of the system. This ownership leads to deeper understanding and pride in work, encouraging thorough testing and careful code review before shipping.

5. **Sustainable Workloads:** Small teams can manage more manageable workloads per person. They avoid burnout by staying within healthy hours and not taking on too much at once. This sustainability ensures consistent quality over time.

However, small team size isn't without challenges:

1. **Limited Skill Diversity:** Smaller teams might lack the variety of skills found in larger teams. This can limit innovation or require external expertise that adds cost and complexity.

2. **\*\*Increased Pressure:\*\*** With fewer people carrying the load, each individual feels more pressure to perform at high levels consistently. This can lead to stress and the need for robust mental health support.

3. **Limited Scaling Potential:** Small teams may struggle with scaling their output without significant investment in automation or additional team members. This limits how much they can grow organically.

### ### Conclusion

Shippability isn't solely about team size -- it's about structure, processes, culture, and technology. Small teams often ship beautifully due to their close-knit nature, but they must also address the challenges through strategies like skill augmentation, stress management, and careful scaling practices.